

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Why are the streets of Hong Kong full of kids in matching T-shirts?

There's nothing quite as crazy as OCamp.

Most countries operate introduction days for students at the start of university, but there's nothing quite as uniquely crazy as the orientation week for new students in Hong Kong (known as 'OCamp').

OCamps tend to run from about three days to a week before a university term starts. Bright-eyed students arrive ready to embark on their all-new college careers. They all have to wear the same t-shirts and do a sequence of crazy activities.

Every OCamp has a "city hunt" – where students are given silly tasks to do all over the city. You might be sent to Fortress to ask for a solar-powered flashlight – an old joke from a Stephen Chow movie – or be told to wave at people in the gym until they wave back.

Then there's the "Campfire". Sometimes there's a circle of flashlights, sometimes there's not, but the whole group joins in and is taught songs and dances.

Students stay up talking, getting to know each other. They have to learn as much as they can about each other before the start of university.

It's frankly crazy, but it works. OCamp is about bringing different students together and giving them a way to bond, starting them out on friendships that will get them through university and beyond. Once you've learned the dance steps to really stupid songs, nothing's ever going to be the same again.

Your principal has asked you to help with an OCamp for new S1 students at your school. Your group is meeting to discuss this. You may want to talk about:

- the advantages and disadvantages of having an OCamp
- activities that would help new students get to know each other
- how to organise the activities
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to join an OCamp?
2. Do you think an OCamp is a good way to meet new friends?
3. Why is it important for students to make new friends at an OCamp?
4. What problems do students face if they can't attend OCamp?
5. Would you enjoy doing a dance in front of lots of people?
6. How else can universities help new students adapt to university life?
7. Who would be better at organising the OCamp: students or teachers?
8. Would an OCamp be a good idea in the workplace?